

SUMMARY

1. Executive Summary

We analysed historical HR data covering 1,470 employees to understand what drives people to leave the company. Our predictive model correctly identifies 85% of employees who are at high risk of quitting. The results show that **attrition is not just about salary**—it is deeply tied to role type, early-career experience, overtime culture, and work-life balance. We recommend prioritising retention efforts for specific job roles and for employees in their first 1–3 years.

2. What Actually Drives Employees to Leave?

Our analysis ranked the most powerful predictors of departure. The top three factors are:

Rank	Factor	What the Data Shows
1	Overtime	Employees who work overtime are 2.5× more likely to leave than those who do not.
2	Years at Company	The highest exit rate occurs among employees with 0–3 years of tenure – they are still settling in but already decide to leave.
3	Job Role	Sales Representatives and Laboratory Technicians have the highest turnover, far exceeding the company average of 16%.

Salary does play a role, but it is not the strongest factor. While leavers do earn slightly less on average, we found that **overtime, work-life balance, and lack of career progression** are equally or more important. An employee who works overtime and has low job satisfaction is highly likely to leave regardless of a moderate pay rise.

3. Which Department / Role Needs Urgent Attention?

Sales and **Research & Development** departments lose the most people, but the highest-risk roles within them are:

- **Sales Representatives** (attrition rate: ~40%)
- **Laboratory Technicians** (attrition rate: ~25%)

We strongly recommend that HR **prioritise these two roles** for immediate retention conversations and intervention.

4. Three Concrete Recommendations

1. **Launch a "First-3-Years" Retention Programme**

Assign every new hire a dedicated mentor and conduct structured stay-interviews at 6, 12, and 24 months. This targets the period when we see the biggest spike in exits.

2. **Review Overtime Policies and Workload**

Since overtime is a major red flag, we should actively monitor teams with high overtime rates and promote flexible working options. Even reducing forced overtime by 10% could significantly reduce attrition risk.

3. **Customised Career Pathways for Sales & Lab Techs**

Create clear internal promotion tracks for these high-risk roles. When employees see a tangible future, they are much less likely to look elsewhere.

5. Important Limitation

Our model finds **correlations, not causes**. For example, working overtime might be a symptom of a toxic manager, not just long hours. Also, the data does not include external market conditions (e.g., competitor offers). We recommend using this model as an **early warning system** to start conversations, not as a definitive firing/hiring decision tool.